Know the GAP!
WTI for Gender Equality

world trade institute

UNIVERSITÄT BERN

INTERSECTIONAL DIS/CONTENTS IN MIGRATION: THAI WOMEN IN BELGIUM, BELGIAN MEN IN THAILAND

8 September 2026
12:30–13:30 CEST
HYBRID EVENT*

Asuncion Fresnoza
F.R.S.-FNRS,
Université libre de Bruxelles

* This event will take place in person at the Anna Nussbaum Auditorium, World Trade Institute, Hallerstrasse 6, 3012 Bern, Switzerland, and online via Zoom. To join remotely, please use this **LINK**

ABSTRACT

The scholarly literature on highly gendered migration phenomena has widely documented how dis/contents – dis/satisfaction with certain aspects of life – can propel people to move out of their countries and pursue their projects abroad. Once in their receiving countries, these individuals undergo several challenges and personal adjustments contingent on their differing social positions in global reproductive system/s. This process accompanies dis/contents at the intersection of individuals' multiple identities. Why and how do dis/contents take shape? How do women and men deal with them? Drawing from two qualitative studies conducted within a span of eight years in Belgium (2012-2015) and in Thailand (2018-2023) respectively, this presentation brings to the fore the intersectional dis/contents of Thai women in Belgium and their Belgian men counterparts in Thailand. Although the study participants highlight the advantages they get from migration, they emphasize some dissatisfactions. The former (mostly marriage migrants) lament about family-related issues and labour market incorporation, whereas the latter (mostly retired men) complain about immigration policies and social security matters. Through the lens of intersectionality, these dis/contents appear not only gendered but also generational (age) and classed. They also stem from larger structural forces, pinpointing the contextuality of intersectional dis/contents in migration.

BIOGRAPHY OF THE SPEAKER



Asuncion Fresnoza-Flot is Tenured Associate Researcher (*Chercheuse Qualifiée*) of the Belgian Fund for Scientific Research (F.R.S.-FNRS) and Senior Lecturer (*Maîtresse d'Enseignement*) at the Laboratory of Anthropology of Contemporary Worlds (LAMC) of the Université libre de Bruxelles (ULB) in Belgium. Since 2004, she has been working on migration-related issues and phenomena in Europe-Asia social spaces, notably involving the Philippines, Thailand, France, Belgium, and the Netherlands. Her recent works include the edited volume *Situated mixedness. Understanding migration-related intimate diversity in Belgium* (Routledge 2025). Her research focuses on the following themes: family, gender, migration, and mobility.

The Gender Lecture Series is organized by the Gender Team of the World Trade Institute – Know the GAP!, led by Prof. Elisa Fornalé, in collaboration with the Faculty of Law of the University of Bern

THIS EVENT IS ORGANIZED AS PART OF THE GENDER LECTURE SERIES 2026-2027

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GENDERED PRECARITIES

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Participation is open to the public and free of charge.

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